

Utku Dagli, MSc

Game Designer

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Professional Summary

Multidisciplinary Game Designer with over 7 years of experience in game development and nearly 4 years in professional development roles. Skilled in designing and implementing gameplay systems, progression mechanics, AI characters, and UX/UI for PC, VR/AR, and mobile platforms. Combines a Computer Engineering foundation with a Master's in Game Studies and Engineering, bringing analytical, problem-solving, and user-experience expertise to every project. Proficient with Unreal Engine, Unity, C++, C#, and Lua, with a strong record of cross-disciplinary collaboration and player-centred design.

Core Skills

Game Design: Game Design, Technical Design, Level Design, Gameplay Systems, Progression Design, AI Design, Gamification, Game Design Documentation, User-Centred Design.

UX & Research: UX Design, UI Design, User Research, Usability Testing, Player Experience, Market Research, Analytics.

Programming: C++, C#, Lua, JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML, CSS, Python.

Engines & Tools: Unreal Engine, Unity, Blender, Visual Studio, Visual Studio Code, JetBrains Rider, WebStorm, Sublime, IntelliJ.

Design Software: Figma, Adobe XD, Adobe Photoshop, GIMP.

Version Control & Collaboration: Git, SVN, Perforce, Jira, Confluence, Trello, Slack, Discord, Microsoft Office, Google Workspace.

Methodologies: Agile, Scrum, Iterative Design, Playtesting, Cross-Functional Collaboration.

Professional Experience

Game Designer | Axiosys (Remote) | November 2025 – Present

- Designed in-game progression, traversal, and exploration mechanics, alongside AI character behaviours, contributing to the core gameplay loop.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to design and maintain sustainable, scalable gameplay systems aligned with team standards.
- Produced design documentation and iterated on systems based on internal feedback and playtesting.

Tutor – Game Studies and Engineering | University of Klagenfurt, Austria | August 2021 – July 2023

- Designed and delivered educational sessions on game design, mechanics, and user experience to graduate-level students.
- Collaborated with academic staff and multidisciplinary teams to enhance learning outcomes and student engagement.
- Mentored students on practical game development projects, providing feedback on design and implementation.

Junior Frontend Developer | Adesso Turkey, Istanbul | August 2020 – February 2021

- Completed an in-depth Angular training programme covering client-side application development, TypeScript, and component-based architecture.
- Applied front-end engineering principles to internal training projects, preparing for client-facing work.

Junior Gameplay Developer / Designer | HES Games, Istanbul | June 2020 - August - 2020

- Contributed as a multifaceted developer in a small team, building core gameplay features in Unreal Engine for the competitive FPS title Sabotaj.
- Shaped game design and UX elements collaboratively, increasing user engagement through iterative testing and design reviews.
- Designed and implemented gameplay and UI/UX features, working closely with art and design disciplines.

Junior Game Developer | GarageAtlas, Istanbul | June 2019 – March 2020

- Initiated and led the implementation of core features for VR/AR projects targeting Oculus Quest headsets.
- Optimised performance and immersion for standalone VR hardware, contributing to projects including Atlas Space and Atlas Home.
- Developed multiplayer functionality and interaction mechanics from early prototype through to production.

Education

MSc, Game Studies and Engineering | 2020 – 2024

University of Klagenfurt, Austria

Master's Thesis: Punishment Mechanics in Video Games – Effects on Player Experience and Flow.

BSc, Computer Engineering | 2014 – 2019

Kadir Has University, Istanbul

Certifications

Google UX Design Professional Certificate – Coursera (Credential: coursera.org/verify/professional-cert/6RYKVJ62CSCG)

Publications

Punishment Mechanics in Video Games: Effects on Player Experience and Flow – Master's Thesis, University of Klagenfurt (2024). Available at: resolver.obvsg.at/urn:nbn:at:at-ubk:1-54367

The Difficulty of Videogames and Intelligence of AI – Play/Write Student Journal, Vol. II (May 2022). DOI: 10.48415/001.2022.02.5

Notable Projects

Mawforged – Dark Fantasy Survival for PC. Current project at Axiosys: designed progression, traversal, exploration mechanics, and AI characters.

Heretic – Roguelike for PC. Worked on design and development, balancing mechanics and stats, designing AI behaviours and attack patterns, and implementing gameplay systems.

Sabotaj – Competitive MMOFPS for PC. Designed and implemented gameplay modes and UI/UX; contributed to development and gameplay design.

Atlas Space – VR experiences for Standalone and Tethered Headsets. Delivered early prototypes, multiplayer functionality, and core interaction mechanics.

VR Crane & Atlas Home – VR porting experience for Standalone and Tethered Headsets.

D.o.E.P (Doors of Endless Possibilities) – 2D top-down adventure game for GameJam. Worked on the user interface and core game mechanics.

Hacker – Top-down puzzle game developed for the Cyberpunk course at the University of Klagenfurt (Unity, itch.io). Developed gameplay, level design, and core mechanics.

Languages

Turkish (Native) | English (Fluent, Professional Working Proficiency) | German (Beginner)